

Margaret Whitfield-Pearson, RN (Ret.)

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22 February

To the Hospital Commander, Stewart Army Community Hospital,

I am writing about the care my mother, **Eleanor R. Whitfield (DOB 04/12/1958, MRN 887-4521)**, received during her stay on the Medical-Surgical ward (Bed 412) from 12 to 19 February. I want to bring something to your attention.

On the night of the 14th, the night-shift nurse — I never got her name — was reviewing my mother's care with the day-shift nurse before she went off duty. I was sitting with my mother and overheard them go through what they called a "structured hand-off." During that hand-off, the night nurse caught that my mother's Coumadin dose had been written incorrectly in the morning order — it would have been double her usual dose. The day nurse stopped, called the doctor, and the order was fixed before my mother received the medication.

I am a retired ICU nurse myself. I know how busy your nurses are and I know how often a quick verbal hand-off misses things. Whatever you are doing now with the structured format — please keep doing it. It very likely prevented a serious problem for my mother. Please pass my thanks to the night nurse, who I believe was working on the 13th-to-14th overnight shift.

Sincerely,

Margaret Whitfield-Pearson

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Daughter of Eleanor R. Whitfield